

“This year, Let’s build something”

So, what are you doing different this year? Depending on what matters to you, the answer of course could be dramatically different. It may also be ‘nothing’ for some. We would like to change that.

Exactly a year ago, I had promised you that all of us at Digit will work very hard to bring about new innovations and to enhance the quality of our content – in print and on the web. True to our promise, we made many changes – many of which you loved and some you asked us to change further: We’ve expanded content coverage, done a redesign, introduced a second dual-layer DVD, and changed, and based on feedback, changed again, the fonts we use. We’ve also revamped our customer and subscription delivery service, and created many new options for you to interact with us and your fellow community members – be it on our web site, or Facebook, Orkut and Twitter. We’ve started webinars and workshops on topics of your interest, which many of you attend with great enthusiasm, and also started Community Chapters, in June 2009, which are quite active in several cities, and offer an opportunity for you to meet each other, share and interact. **2009 was truly a year of change for Digit.**

What has helped us all along is the regular feedback we get from you – frank, brutal and mostly constructive – through letters and emails you write to us, your posts on the thinkdigit.com forum, and your participation in community surveys. You’ve given us a lot of ideas to work on – an example is starting the Digit fan page on Facebook. Please keep it this way, it is our biggest strength. **Your involvement is most precious to us**, and it makes us unique. You now also have a direct line to the Editor, on our forum (www.thinkdigit.com/d/editor/).

You will be happy to know that Digit has not only emerged yet again as the number one technology magazine in India, in the 2009 Indian Readership Survey (R2), but has also increased its lead significantly. The survey also indicates that **a lot of new readers have joined the community. Thank you for making us proud once again.**

Now, back to the question I asked earlier – what are you doing different this year? At Digit, when we look at the world around us: our community and its preferences, the trends in technology and tools for creating applications, the unprecedented economic upheaval, creating the need for new business models and skills, it all seems to shout out to us: **This year, let’s build something.**

We’ve decided to offer more content to help you build things – build products, build applications, build careers and even build businesses. Hundreds of you participated in a survey on entrepreneurship we conducted recently. A large section of our community seems to want to start a business. Well the timing could not be better in my opinion. To help you get started, we are introducing a



Asheesh Gupta, Publishing Director

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new section on entrepreneurship from this month. It will provide you with practical tips, lessons from successful technology entrepreneurs – many of whom started like you, provide you with the opportunity to get your questions answered by experts, and much more. This month, we’re featuring two successful entrepreneurs (pg 22) who started from scratch to build successful businesses. **We’re also going to provide you with more DIY workshops** and articles – on both software and hardware, so you can build something for yourself, your family or for the place you work or study.

Let’s also build more bridges to connect us this year, and make our community stronger than ever. We have recently constituted a Community Advisory Council representing a cross-section of our readers (you will find their names on pg 2) to help us with this. You can personally contribute to building the community by introducing new readers, participating in the thinkdigit.com forum, commenting on articles online, joining in our activities, contests, surveys etc., and spreading the word. Together, let’s build for a great future. A very happy 2010 to you!

Asheesh Gupta